

Raleigh Tanzania Volunteer report for Francis Nyonzo

Volunteer in Tanzania, September - December 2018

About Raleigh International

Raleigh International is a sustainable development charity. We harness the passion and energy of young people to effect positive change in sustainable development. Our programmes focus on providing access to safe water and sanitation, protecting vulnerable environments and building resilient communities.

Our work is delivered through young people and is a collaboration between local communities, partners and volunteers from a wide range of backgrounds, nationalities and life stages. We operate in partnership with communities, non-governmental organisations and governments in Borneo, Costa Rica, Nicaragua, Nepal and Tanzania. Since our foundation as a charity in 1984, Raleigh volunteers have become a global community of more than 40,000 people committed to building a sustainable future.

International Citizen Service Overview

International Citizen Service (ICS) is a UK Government programme funded by the Department for International Development (DFID). The programme is delivered through young people from the UK and host countries with the overarching objective of positive and sustainable change in some of the world's poorest communities. Raleigh International is one of a number of consortium partners who deliver the ICS programme.

Raleigh Tanzania's ICS programmes focus on two programmatic areas: Water, Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH), and Rural Youth Livelihoods. Our work is delivered by Tanzanian and UK volunteers in collaboration with grassroots partner organisations and local communities.

Raleigh Tanzania ICS Livelihoods

The world's youth population is growing at a rate faster than ever before. By percentage, Tanzania has the world's tenth largest youth population and this is expected to continue to grow in coming years. Unemployment, particularly in rural areas, is one of the key challenges facing the youth population. Rural youth generally have less access to education, training, finance and other opportunities and are a marginalised group of society. Whilst Tanzania has over recent years benefited from a growing GDP, the effects of this are largely felt by a small percentage of the population and rarely filter down to those living in rural and poor areas. The Tanzanian government has identified the development and increase of small and medium sized enterprises as one of the key approach to address this issue. Raleigh Tanzania's ICS Livelihoods programme therefore aims to equip rural youth with the skills, knowledge and confidence required to start, maintain or develop small or medium sized enterprises in rural parts of Tanzania.

As part of the ICS Livelihoods programme, volunteers aged 18-25 are recruited from the UK and Tanzania to spend 10 - 12 weeks living and working in a rural Tanzanian community. All volunteers take part in selection process to ensure their suitability and motivation for what is a challenging and demanding programme. Volunteers work in teams of approximately 12 people

Raleigh Tanzania
P.O. Box 729 Morogoro, Tanzania
Tel. & Fax +255 (0)62 565 8783
E-mail: a.copping@raleightanzania.org
www.raleighinternational.org

and a 1:1 ratio of UK and Tanzanian participants. Each volunteer team is lead and supported by one UK and Tanzanian Team Leader.

Training and delivery

Upon arrival, volunteers complete an induction programme consisting of theoretical and practical briefings and activities designed to equip them for the demands of the programme. This training includes basic first aid, health and safety protocols, risk assessment, cultural awareness, youth leadership, sustainable development and specific programmatic training to enable them to deliver the livelihoods entrepreneur curriculum. The entrepreneur curriculum includes entrepreneur recruitment and preparation, principles of entrepreneurship, idea generation, market research, business model canvas, cash flow, access to finance, business mentorship and local support networks. The curriculum is delivered to entrepreneurs on a 1:1 and group basis and the success of the programme is dependent on the formation of successful working relationships between volunteers and entrepreneurs.

Placement learning and development

The ICS programme is based on an experiential and reflective learning methodology that is a powerful way of developing skills, knowledge, awareness and capabilities. Volunteers are encouraged to reflect on their personal goals and learning objectives, and progress is reviewed throughout the programme, including one to one sessions and a structured volunteer competency appraisal system designed to encourage reflection and goal focussed thinking. In addition, open and constructive feedback during group review sessions is encouraged and facilitated amongst team members.

This ICS placement provides the opportunity for development in the following areas:

Leadership

Volunteers take on the role of weekly leader on a rotational basis throughout the programme. As weekly leader the volunteer is responsible for the planning and execution of the week's activities. They are required to brief the group, delegate tasks in an appropriate and fair manner, and conduct regular reviews to monitor and evaluate progress. All of this is completed in a challenging and unfamiliar environment, working with a multi-national and multi-language team where learning styles and abilities are often varied.

Teamwork

On each project, volunteers worked in a diverse group of volunteers - people with different motivations, work ethics, attitudes, cultures, religions and life experiences. The team have to live and work together for a prolonged period of time in often intense circumstances. The situation therefore, purposefully challenges them to listen to each other, understand each other's strengths and weaknesses, allocate roles and responsibilities, overcome conflict and motivate one another to achieve the project goals.

Problem solving, innovation and adaptability

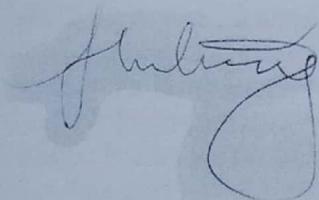
During the ICS programme, volunteers have to learn to adapt to, and to resolve unplanned events. Bad weather, vehicle breakdowns, medical situations, challenging community relations etc. can mean individual and groups have to learn to cope under pressure and find innovative solutions to often challenging situations. This requires flexibility and a solution focused approach on the part of the volunteers.

Confidence and self-awareness

The intensive social environment of living and working with the team on the ICS programme means that all volunteers learn a lot about themselves during their time here. Individuals learn about their preferences, their boundaries, how to cope under pressure, solve problems, live without home comforts, adapt to different cultures and learn about their own strengths and weaknesses. They have the opportunity to meet people and make new friends, and perform tasks they may have previously felt were beyond their abilities. This experience of stepping out of one's comfort zone develops confidence and self-awareness in a way that may not be possible in life at home.

Francis has made a valued and positive contribution to this ICS programme in Tanzania. Their commitment and dedication to the values and ethos of Raleigh has demonstrated their ability to positively impact on the lives of those around them. We are confident that this experience will impact positively on Francis's outlook, personal potential and active engagement in their home community and we are pleased to welcome to our alumni of like-minded people who share the common Raleigh experience.

I would like to thank Francis for committing the time and energy to volunteer on the Raleigh ICS Livelihoods programme.

**Alice Copping**

Country Operations Manager
Raleigh Tanzania

Raleigh Tanzania
P.O. Box 729 Morogoro, Tanzania
Tel. & Fax +255 (0)62 565 8783
E-mail: a.copping@raleightanzania.org
www.raleighinternational.org